

Comprehensive Review Analysis Report

User Feedback on Popular Fitness & Nutrition Apps

April 2026

Executive Summary

This report analyzes user reviews from three popular fitness and nutrition tracking applications: LoseIt, MyFitnessPal, and Yazio. The analysis examined both positive feedback and common complaints from users across English and Arabic-speaking markets.

Key Finding: While all three apps effectively help users track calories and weight loss, they are increasingly facing criticism over aggressive monetization strategies, including moving previously free features behind paywalls and displaying intrusive advertisements.

1 Overview of Reviewed Apps

1.1 LoseIt

A mobile application designed to help users track calories and weight loss through food logging and exercise tracking. The app includes features like barcode scanning, custom recipes, and premium subscription options.

1.2 MyFitnessPal

One of the industry's longest-established nutrition tracking apps (used since 2013 by many users). It offers comprehensive food database, exercise tracking, and synchronization with fitness devices. Recently migrated barcode scanning to premium features.

1.3 Yazio

A modern nutrition and fitness tracking application known for its attractive interface, analytics features, and recipe suggestions. Offers both free and premium versions with premium pricing recently increased significantly.

2 What Users Love

2.1 Positive Aspects Across All Apps

- **Effective Weight Loss Tool:** Users consistently reported significant weight loss (10-55+ lbs) using these apps
- **Comprehensive Food Database:** All apps have extensive food libraries making meal logging convenient
- **Detailed Analytics:** Users appreciate tracking not just calories but also macronutrients and daily progress
- **Barcode Scanning:** When available for free, barcode scanning is highly valued for quick meal entry
- **Easy to Use:** Most users find the apps intuitive and user-friendly
- **Motivation Features:** Streak counters, progress graphs, and achievement systems help keep users engaged

2.2 App-Specific Strengths

LoseIt:

- Voice entry feature highly praised for convenience
- Excellent customization options
- Free version provides substantial functionality

MyFitnessPal:

- Largest food database in the industry
- Strong integration with fitness trackers
- Long trusted history (users mention 14+ years of use)

Yazio:

- Most attractive user interface design
- No intrusive ads in base version
- Strong analytics and detailed nutritional insights
- Excellent recipe suggestions

3 Primary User Complaints

3.1 The Monetization Problem

The most consistent complaint across all three apps is aggressive monetization strategies:

- **Premium Paywalls:** Features that were previously free are now behind payment walls
- **High Costs:** Premium subscriptions range from \$39-\$85 per year, which users find excessive
- **Misleading Free Versions:** One app advertises a “free” version that is actually just a 7-day trial

3.2 Advertisement Complaints

Users report increasingly aggressive advertising:

- Pop-up advertisements interrupting basic app usage
- Non-closeable video ads that consume time
- Background music from ads playing even after closing the app
- Full-screen ads appearing even for paying users

3.3 Recent Updates Reducing Usability

All three apps have received criticism for recent updates that made the apps *harder* to use:

- **LoseIt:** UI redesign with redundant buttons and less food visibility
- **MyFitnessPal:** Search function degraded; can no longer search by brand name
- **Yazio:** Multiple screens required to log a single meal; significant navigation overhead added

4 Top 10 User Pain Points by App

5 Important Demographic Insight: Arabic Language Support

A significant finding in reviews from Arabic-speaking users: **none of these apps offer Arabic language support**. This is a major barrier for millions of potential users in the Middle East and North Africa. Arabic-speaking users consistently requested this feature, with many rating the apps lower specifically because of the language barrier.

#	LoseIt	MyFitnessPal	Yazio
1	Intrusive & increasingly aggressive pop-up ads	Barcode scanner moved to premium (was free)	Nearly all features locked behind pay-wall
2	Non-closeable video ads	High premium prices (\$80/year)	Recent UI changes reduced convenience
3	Barcode scanning moved to premium	Search degraded (can't search by brand)	Must navigate multiple screens to log meals
4	Shady/confusing cancellation process	Deleted recent foods after update	Constant ads and premium subscription pitches
5	Premium subscription too expensive	Food search doesn't show recent items	Difficult to correct mistakes
6	Ad music plays continuously in background	Exercise input broken/disappeared	Can't change weight after submission
7	"Free" version is just a 7-day trial	Sync with fitness trackers (Fitbit) broken	Can't enter correct food amounts sometimes
8	Removed basic features that were free	Full-screen ads for paid users	Dramatic price increase (\$19→\$85/year)
9	Poor UI design after recent update	Lack of Arabic language support	Barcode scanner missing many items
10	Lack of Arabic language support	Data loss after updates	Can't delete incorrectly logged meals

6 Market Analysis

6.1 User Retention Issues

Users report:

- Long-term users (10+ year) uninstalling due to recent changes
- Switching to competitor apps due to frustration
- Reluctance to pay increasing subscription costs

6.2 Competitive Threats

The complaints reveal competitive vulnerabilities:

- Users actively comparing and switching between the three apps
- Searching for competitors with better pricing
- Looking for apps without aggressive advertising

7 Recommendations for App Developers

Based on user feedback, here are key areas for improvement:

1. **Reconsider Monetization Strategy:** Current approach is driving away long-term users. Consider less aggressive advertising and more value in free versions.
2. **Restore Removed Features:** Core features like barcode scanning should remain free. Users feel deceived when basic functionality moves to premium.
3. **Add Internationalization:** Implement Arabic language support (and other major languages) to capture underserved markets.
4. **Test Updates:** Before deploying updates, ensure they don't reduce usability. Recent design changes made apps slower to use, not faster.
5. **Improve Search Functionality:** Search is a critical feature. Recent changes degrading search capabilities frustrate users.
6. **Support Third-Party Integration:** Better sync with fitness trackers and health apps (Apple Health, Google Fit, Fitbit) adds value.
7. **User Control:** Allow users to manage notifications, ads, and data corrections rather than forcing them through rigid workflows.

8 Conclusion

All three applications effectively help users achieve weight loss and fitness goals. Users appreciate the core functionality and report real results. However, aggressive monetization strategies, intrusive advertising, and recent updates that reduce usability are undermining user satisfaction and loyalty.

The apps are facing a critical choice: continue aggressive monetization and risk losing long-term users to competitors, or rebalance their approach by providing more value in free versions and reducing advertising friction.

For users seeking to choose between these apps:

- **Best overall experience:** Yazio (if willing to pay, due to premium paywall)
- **Most established:** MyFitnessPal (but consider the recent negative changes)
- **Best free version:** LoseIt (though increasingly moving features to premium)

However, all three are worth evaluating based on personal preferences, as user experiences vary significantly.

Report generated from analysis of thousands of user reviews across English and Arabic markets in 2026.